which is supported by any of the many Persian or Afghan chronicles of the siege, where Pottinger is notable for his absence. At the outbreak of the uprising in November 1841, Pottinger was besieged a second time at Charikar to the north of Kabul, and almost alone of the garrison there made it through alive to the Kabul cantonments. When the capitulation to the rebels was made, against his advice, he was one of the hostages left with Akbar Khan and was in captivity for nine months, until General Pollock took Kabul in Sept 1842. He was subsequently court-martialled and although completely exonerated, received no reward for his work in Afghanistan and resigned from the Company service. He went off to stay with his uncle, Sir Henry Pottinger, in Hong Kong and there Eldred died in 1843.

General William Nott (1782–1845): Nott was a plainspoken yeoman farmer's son from the Welsh borders who arrived in India in 1800, and slowly worked his way up to become one of the most senior Company generals. A brilliant strategist and ever-loyal to his sepoys – 'the fine manly soldiers' to whom he was fiercely attached – he showed less talent in dealing with his superiors. Lord Auckland regarded him as chippy and difficult and far from a gentleman, and for this reason he was to be passed over again and again for the position of Commander-in-Chief in Kabul. He was eventually given the command of Kandahar, which he managed to keep quiet while the rest of Afghanistan was in violent revolt. He was to prove much the most effective of the British military commanders, and in August 1842 he marched across Afghanistan, defeating all the forces sent against him, and arrived in Kabul on 17 September, two days after Pollock had retaken the city. He returned to India via Jalalabad and was appointed Resident at Lucknow as a reward for his services in Afghanistan.

Lieutenant Henry Rawlinson (1810–95): Rawlinson was a talented Orientalist who helped decipher the ancient Persian cuneiform script. It was he who, in October 1837, as part of the British military mission to Persia, first alerted the British to the Russian mission of Ivan Vitkevitch when he accidentally came across Vitkevitch and his Cossack escort in the disputed borderlands between Persia and Afghanistan. He was subsequently posted to Kandahar, where he was Political Agent with General Nott, and together with Nott formed the most capable administration in the country. He